

5TH ITASEAS CONFERENCE

THE ITALIAN ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHEAST ASIAN STUDIES

JUNE 4-6, 2025
UNIVERSITY OF TURIN - CAMPUS LUIGI EINAUDI
TORINO | ITALY



partners



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PROGRAMME

Welcome to **ITASEAS 2025**, the 5th conference of ITASEAS, this year held at the **University of Turin, Campus Einaudi 4-6th June 2025** and organized jointly by the University of Turin, the University of Naples L'Orientale and the University of Milan–Bicocca.

Founded in 2007, the **Italian Association for Southeast Asian Studies** (ITASEAS) aims to stimulate the study and the dissemination of knowledge in the field of Southeast Asian studies within Italy.

The conference brings together scholars, experts, practitioners and students of diverse disciplines into an international debate.

The Convenors wish to thank the Department of Cultures, Politics and Society of the University of Turin for the economic, administrative and logistics support. The conference has been supported by ISA - Institute of Studies on Asia of the University of Turin and MyERN - Myanmar European Research Network. Our immense gratitude goes also to our partners Clubasia, the Department of Human Sciences for Education “Riccardo Massa” of the University of Milan Bicocca, the Embassy of Malaysia in Rome and ISMEO - The International Association for Mediterranean and Oriental Studies for contributing with financial support. Last but not least, T.wai - Torino World Affairs Institute, a key player in Italy on International Relations of Asia, has organized the TOASEAN Culture Days, with a rich program of roundtables and book launches.

The Campus Luigi Einaudi and Turin are ready to welcome you all in June, when the Italian spring is in full swing. We wish you all a pleasant and fruitful stay and we hope to welcome you again on campus in the future.

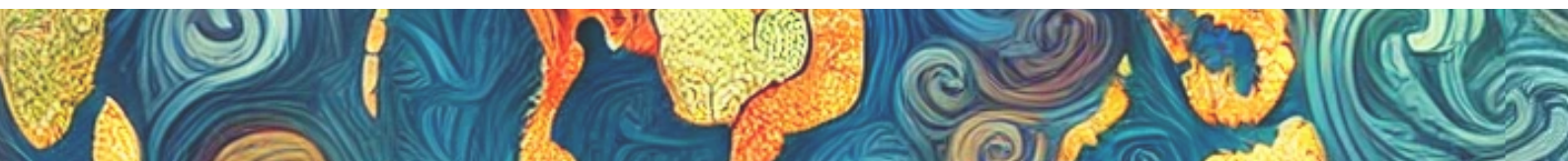
Enjoy the conference!

The Convenors:

- **Giuseppe Gabusi**, University of Turin
- **Pietro Masina**, University of Naples L'Orientale
- **Antonia Soriente**, University of Naples L'Orientale
- **Silvia Vignato**, University of Milan–Bicocca

Organising committee:

- **Giuseppe Gabusi**, University of Turin
- **Elisa Gasco** (Program officer) University of Turin
- **Luigi Sausa** (Program officer) University of Naples L'Orientale
- **Antonia Soriente**, University of Naples L'Orientale
- **Silvia Vignato**, University of Milan–Bicocca



WEDNESDAY 4 JUNE

Campus Luigi Einaudi Main Hall, ground floor

14:00 – 15:00 Registration and welcome coffee

Plenary | Sala laurea blu grande

15:00 – 15:30 Institutional greetings

15:30 – 16:30 Keynote speech: **Chiara Formichi** - Domestic nationalism: “home” as a policy in Indonesia

16:30 – 17:30 **H.E. Dato’ Zahid Rastam** - Ambassador of Malaysia to Italy - Explaining ASEAN 2025 Malaysia Chair and ASEAN Community Vision 2045

17:30 – 18:00 Coffee Break-courtesy of the Embassy of Malaysia in Rome | Room 3D440

18:00 – 20:00 Parallel sessions

Session 1 | Sala laurea rossa grande | PRIN SISEA Symbolic Inequality in Southeast Asia 1

Chair: **Silvia Vignato**

Silvia Vignato - Considerations on The Anthropology of Inequality Based on a “Famous” Drug-dealing Neighbourhood in Medan

Roberto Rizzo - Of Spaces and Spears. Sangir Migration and labour across Indonesia’s maritime border

Antonia Soriente - Inequality and Education: The Case of the Punan Semeriot Indigenous School in Kalimantan

Guido Creta - Bersih Lingkungan and Screening Mental: The Long-lasting Repercussions of the 1965-66 Political Purges in Indonesia

Session 2 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | New and Old Models of Inspiration

Chair: **Luigi Sausa**

Paulus Bagus Sugiyono - Examining “Bhinneka Tunggal Ika” as Indonesia’s Shared Political Value as a Multiethnic Nation

Geradi Yudhistira - The politics of Habib as Spiritual gurus in Indonesia: Between Morality and Pragmatism

Amida Yusriana, Carolin Ischen, Lawrence Ang, Edith Smit - Understanding How K-food Is Adopted in The Lives of Young Indonesian Consumers Promoted by Social Media Influencers

Zakiyatul Mufidah - Islamic Feminist Digital Activism: The Promotion of Gender Equality in Indonesian Social Media Landscape

Session 3 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Future Landscapes

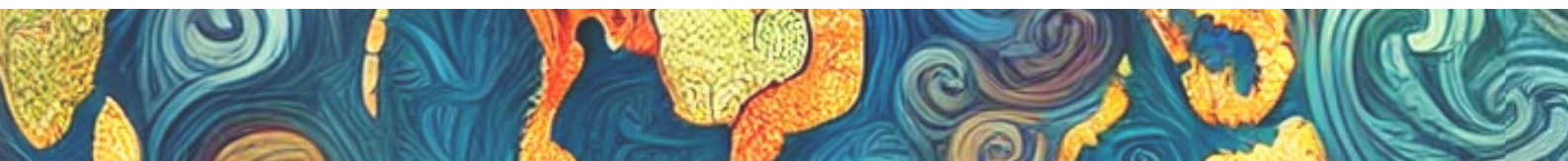
Chair: **Michele Farina**

Haruming Sekar Saraswati - Human Rights Controversies in the Development of the New Capital City of Indonesia

Soleman Karmani - Transitional Perspectives (-Dark to Light-) on Climate Change from Pura Island, Alor Archipelago, Eastern Indonesia

Martin Elvanyus De Porres - Not the Coconut but the Land: The Resistance of the Indigenous Communities in the Religious-based Corporate Plantation in Flores, Indonesia

Claudine Ang Tsu Lyn - Power and Magical Objects in Vietnam: From the Turtle’s Claw to Le Loi’s Sword



THURSDAY 5 JUNE

Plenary | Sala laurea blu grande

9:00 - 10:00 Keynote Speech: **Nicholas Farrelly** (University of Tasmania) - Southeast Asia's 21st century geopolitics: Speculation and knowledge

10:00 -11:00 ITASEAS Plenary Meeting

11:00 - 11:30 Break - On the ground floor, there are coffee and water vending machines

11:30 - 13:00 Parallel sessions

Session 4 | Sala laurea rossa grande | PRIN SISEA Symbolic Inequality in Southeast Asia 2

Chair: **Pietro Masina**

Giuseppe Bolotta - Children of the Kingdom: Contesting Thai Childhood in the Age of Protest

Johanna M. Götz - Aesthetics of Resistance: Symbolic Imaginaries and The 2021 Burma/ Myanmar Spring Revolution.

Aniello Iannone, Sri Endah Kinasih Irfan Wahyudi - Unequal Exchange and Labor Exploitation: Indonesian Migrant Workers in Taiwan's Fishing Industry

Marco Del Gallo - The Politics and Legality of "emerging land" in North Jakarta

Session 5 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | Languages and Legacies

Chair: **Antonia Soriente**

Eko Widiyanto - From Initiative to Institution: Toenggoel Siagian and the Rise of Teaching Bahasa Indonesia in the U.S.

Roberta Zollo - Revealing Colonial Legacies and Redefining Museum Practices: The Provenance of Indonesian Ethnographic Collections in Niedersachsen

K. W. Taylor - Brick Tombs in Vietnamese Archaeology and History

Trang Phan - The Evolution of Sino-Vietnamese Negative Prefixes: Language Contact, Cultural Exchange, and Linguistic Adaptation

Session 6 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Buddhism and the Nation

Chair: **Tomas Larsson**

Tomas Larsson, Stithorn Thananithichot - Mapping Thailand's New Religio-political Cleavages: Religious nationalists and their rivals

Edoardo Siani - Prophecy and New Political Imaginaries in Thailand

Maria Vittoria Nenna - Signaling in the House of Buddha: Skill, Merit and Neoliberal Agency at Wat Phra Dhammakaya

Wynn Gadkar-Wilcox - The Origins of Moderation: Reading Thích Tâm Châu (1921-2015)

13:00 - 14:30 Lunch - Room 3D440

15:30 - 17:30 Parallel sessions

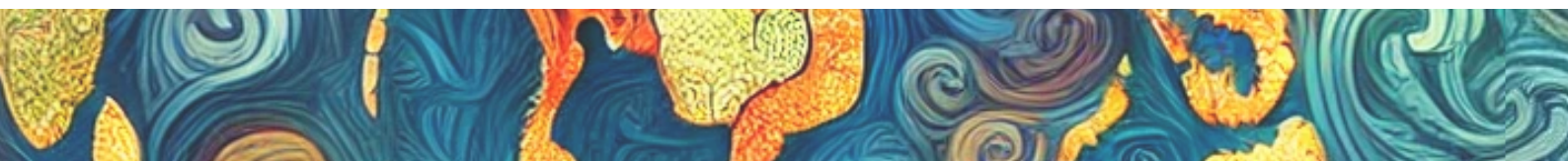
Session 7 | Sala laurea rossa grande | Making Society through Culture

Chair: **Bernard Sellato**

Elio Della Monica - Unraveling Arisan and Gotong-royong: A Systematic Literature Review of Their Socio-economic Impact

Dwi Winarsih - Transformations in the Role of Indonesian 'Tengkulak': Economic and Social Implications

Yanu Endar Prasetyo, Dwi Winarsih, Antoine Huerta - Redesigning Social Protection for Artists: Lessons from France for Indonesia



Session 8 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | Networks of Power in Southeast Asian Democracies

Chair: **Raimondo Neironi**

Budi Setiyono, Aniello Iannone, Wahid Abdulrahman and Muhammad Adnan - Money, Politics and Worker Voter Behavior in Indonesia: A Study of Central Java in the 2024 Presidential Election

Adam Tyson - A New Presidential Dynasticism in Indonesia? Evidence From The 2024 Elections

Tomáš Petrů - Towards a Neo-New Order? Reassessing Embedded Authoritarian Legacies in Indonesia's Democratic Regression

Raimondo Neironi - All in the Family: Political Dynasties and The Failed Fantasies of Electoral Democracy in the Philippines

Martin Petlach - Lost votes, Hidden Stories: Understanding Invalid Ballots in Southeast Asia

Session 9 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Communities' Dynamics and The Struggles in Indonesian Socio-political Landscape

Chair: **Gloria Truly Estrelita**

Dr. Gregorius Budi Subanar - The Jesuit in Indonesia in Relation with Hinduism and Buddhism in the 20th century

Gloria Truly Estrelita - Political Repression and Religious Response: The Catholic Church's Role in Indonesian Carceral System (1965-1981)

Eduardo Erlanga Drestanta - The Politics of Customary Villages (Desa Adat) in Seram Island, Maluku: Dynamics, Ethnic Conflicts, and Religious Tensions

Jidapa Buayairugsa - Religious Spaces as Social Safety Nets: The Role of Temples and Churches in Supporting Thai Marriage Migrants in Taiwan

17:30 - 18:00 Coffee Break - Room 3D440

18:00 - 19:30 Parallel sessions

Session 10 | Sala laurea rossa grande | Imageries and Local Identities

Chair: **Luigi Monteanni**

Eva Rapoport - Co-creating with non-humans: How Spirit Possession in Southeast Asian Arts Can Inform Our Understanding of Generative AI

Luigi Monteanni - Farmers in Corpse Paint: Narrating Identity and Extreme Metal Ideology Through the Countryside Imagery in West Java

Daniele Zappatore - Summoning the Ancestral Spirits: Behind the Scenes of a Participatory Documentary on Javanese Music and Trance

Agung Wibowo, Elise Patole Edoumba - Javanese Performing Arts on Display at The Natural History Museum of La Rochelle

Session 11 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | Travelling Visions

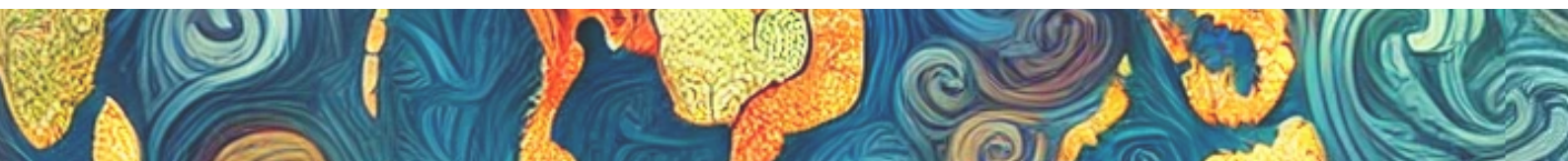
Chair: **Ilaria Meloni**

Ilaria Meloni - Anoman the Messenger... in Venice: Staging Javanese Wayang Kulit for an Italian Audience

Francesco De Bellis - "We keep spending most of our lives livin' in the Gangster's Paradise" the re-appropriation and re-contextualization of Filipino diaspora through kulintang.

Thuy Hien Le - Political Cartoon as a Mirror of Society. The Case of Vietnam

Olga Dror - Cultivating Ho Chi Minh in Europe



18:00 - 19:30 Parallel sessions

Session 12 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Migrant Workers and the Stateless in Thailand: The Limitations of Social, Political, and Economic Belonging

Chair: Pinkaew Laungaramsri

Rosalia Sciortino - Crisis and Migration in Thailand

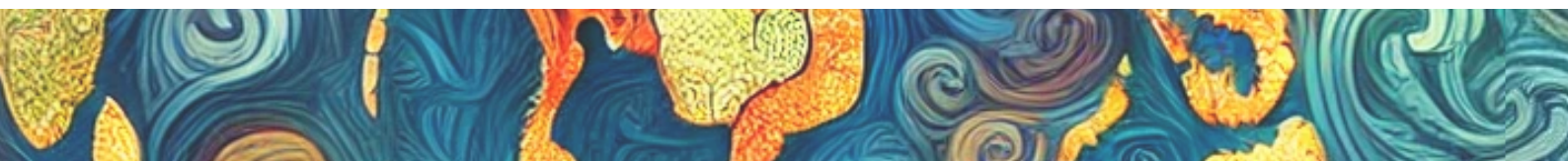
Suchada Thaweesit - A Community-Led Model for Resolving the Legal Identity of Undocumented Status and Statelessness in Thailand

Malee Sunpuwan - Still Valued, but Perceived With Concern: Bangkok Residents' Views on Migrant Workers

Sudarat Musikawong - Migrant Worker Precarity: Bilateral Formalization in Thailand's Agricultural Sector

20:30

Social dinner at **COMBO Restaurant**, Corso Regina Margherita 128 - Turin



FRIDAY 6 JUNE

9:00 - 11:00 Parallel sessions

Session 13 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | Languages

Chair: **Antonia Soriente**

Bernard Sellato - Food Plants and Historical Subsistence Transitions in Borneo: A Linguistic Approach

Luigi Sausa - What We Talk About When We Talk About Bahasa Majlas: A Semiotic Register Among the Arab Descendants in Indonesia

Francesca R. Moro - Family Language Policy among first and second-generation Filipinos in Italy

Elsie Marie T. Or - Language Maintenance in the Filipino Diaspora: The Case of Filipinos in Campania, Italy

Patrizia Pacioni - Khmer Demonstrative and Classifiers Distributions

Session 14 | Sala laurea rossa grande | Struggling Myanmar

Chair: **Stefano Ruzza**

Michał Lubina - Russia-Myanmar Relations. The Dilemmas of a Patron-Client Relationship

Lalu Tandur - Between the Junta and the NUG: Rohingya Rights in Myanmar's Uncertain Future

Khin Zaw - From Liberation Wars to a New Nation

Alessia D'Ortona - Myanmar's Crisis and Regional Power Diplomacy: A Comparative Analysis of Key Actors

Session 15 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Historical Settings of the Colonial Power

Chair: **Guido Creta**

Ubaldo Iaccarino - Connections Across Waters: The Dynamics of the Early Modern Sino-Japanese Trade in the Philippines

Supasai Vongkulbhisal - Built to Rule: Western Architectural Influence and Elite Autonomy in Thailand.

Nicholas Y. H. Wong - Liu Renhang's Interwar Nanyang Pacifism: A Huaqiao Intellectual's Travelogue on Gender, Religion, and Utopia

Giovanni Giurati, Francesca Billeri, Gianluca Chelini - Dialogic Practices in Ethnographic Archives: Insights From an Ethnomusicological Project on Khmer Music

11:00 - 11:30 Break - On the ground floor, there are coffee and water vending machines

11:30 - 13:00 Parallel sessions

Session 16 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | People Across Borders

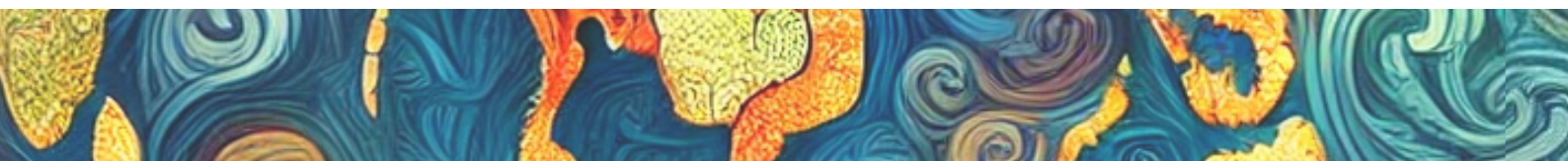
Chair: **Valentina Grillo**

Salai Vanni Bawi - Contrasting Responses: Thailand's and India's Approaches to Myanmar's Refugee Crisis After 2021 Coup

Valentina Grillo - Is dhoroni to daī as Southeast Asia is to South Asia?

Nicolo Deiana - Women and Migrants in the Electronics Global Production Network: Waves of Adverse Incorporation in Vietnam and Malaysia

Pinkaew Laungaramsri - The Politics of Reproduction: The History of Sexuality and Nation in Thailand



Session 17 | Sala laurea rossa grande | Tourism and the Commodification of Embodied Culture

Chair: **Roberto Rizzo**

Giada Donzel - Tourism and Identity: The Case of The H'Mông people in Việt Nam

Gianluca Chelini - Listening Tourism: Sonic Zoning and Sonic Bureaucratization in Siem Reap, Cambodia

Jirasak Rakkarn - Corruption and Tourism Demand: Evidence from Thailand's Inbound Tourism Market (2000-2019)

Giulia Sala - Barong dance in Bali: touristic ritual

Session 18 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Legality and Normality

Chair: **Silvia Vignato**

Angie Ngọc Trần - Weakening of Social Protection in Vietnam: Labor Legislation, Cicada Capital, Civil Society

Thi Anh Thu Dinh - Normalizing Illegality: A Case Study Transnational Labor Migration in Central Vietnam

Bridget Welsh - Transnational Crime Trends in Southeast Asia

Nanda Amalia - Judicial Journeys: Voices and Challenges in Accessing The Syar'iyah Courts of Pidie and Singkel, Aceh, Indonesia

13:00-14:30 Lunch - Room 3D440

14:30 - 16:00 Parallel sessions

Session 19 | Sala laurea rossa piccola | Myanmar After the Coup

Chair: **Rosalia Sciortino**

Win Win May, Ei Shwe Sin Phyo, Myo Myo Kyaw - Media outlets in Myanmar following the 2021 coup

Myo Myo Kyaw - Resistance Governance in Sagaing Region: The Role of People's Administration Bodies

Stefano Ruzza, Davide Pellegrino - From Coup to Fragmentation: Myanmar's Post-2021 Conflict and the Reconfiguration of Resistance

Licia Proserpio - Myanmar Spring Universities: Reflecting on the Nexus Between Higher Education and Displacement

Session 20 | Sala laurea rossa grande | Nations in Competition

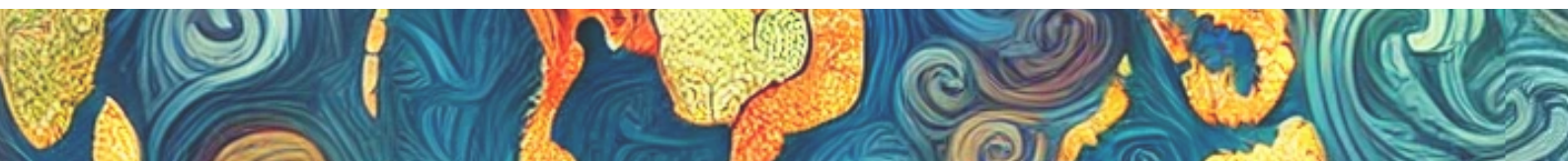
Chair: **Pietro Masina**

Khanh Dau Ngoc Bao - Making Sense of Vietnam's Foreign Policy Amid Great Powers Competition

Thiem Hai Bui - The Sweeping Government Efficiency Waves in Southeast Asia: Vietnam's Bureaucratic Reform and Implications for a New Power Structure of the Party-State in Vietnam

Anthika Manowong - Thailand's Middle-Income Trap: Brain Drain and Seniority Culture - A Study of Skilled Labor Migration

Michele Farina - The Ripple Effect. Social Movement Impact on Party Dynamics in Southeast Asia: The Thai Case



Session 21 | Sala laurea blu piccola | Southeast Asia in Larger Networks

Chair: **Bridget Welsh**

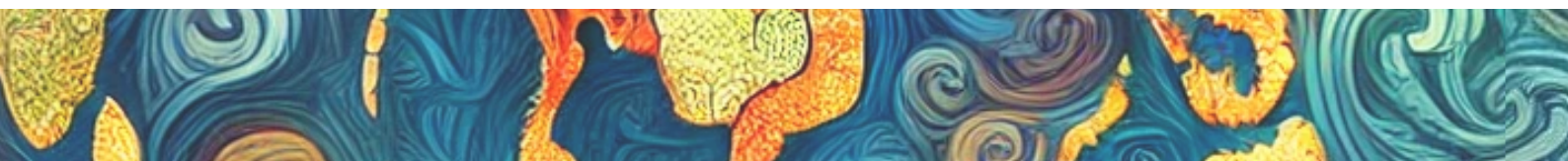
Ariff Hafizi Radzi - Mapping and Process Geographies as a Method: Islamic Network between Southeast Asia and the Middle East during the Long 1960s

Su Min Clare Cho - ASEAN and Myanmar: The Rise of Authoritarian Regionalism in Southeast Asia

Mukti Estu Sarwo - Championing Change: Indonesia's Role in Advancing Women, Peace, and Security in ASEAN

Aries A. Arugay, Matteo Piasentini, Mico A. Galang - Middle Power, Great Challenges: The Philippines' Role in Upholding the Indo-Pacific Order

Presentation Time: Each contribution is allocated 20 minutes - 15 minutes for the talk, followed by 5 minutes for Q&A.



PRACTICALITIES

The Conference will be held at the Luigi Einaudi Campus of the University of Turin. The Luigi Einaudi Campus is located along the banks of the Dora River in the former Italgas industrial area, a short distance from the Mole Antonelliana.

The rooms for the conference are:

- Sala lauree grande blu
- Sala lauree piccola blu
- Sala lauree grande rossa
- Sala lauree piccola rossa

They are all located on the ground floor, just left to the bull statue at main gate of the campus (Lungodora Siena 100/A).

Coffee breaks, lunch, and social dinner

- Two coffee breaks (the one on the afternoon of June 4 and the one on the afternoon of June 5th) are being held in room 3D440, which is located on the 3rd floor. You can take the lift behind the desk in the main hall.
- Coffee machines or water vending machines are on the ground floor, next to the conference rooms.
- Lunch will be served in room 3D440.
- Social dinner will be organized on June 5 at 8:30 pm at COMBO Restaurant, Corso Regina Margherita, 128, Turin.

How to get to Torino:

By plane:

- from Malpensa Airport
- from Turin Airport

By train:

- Trenitalia (Train)
- Italo (Train)

For detailed information please visit the ["Università L'Orientale" web page](#)

